

INTRODUCTION

Preface

Authorized by the Florida Bureau of Fire Standards and Training (BFST), the intent of the Performance Objectives is to provide continuity of minimum standards for fire training academies, instructors, and examiners throughout the State of Florida. The contents of this manual are formatted with practical skills to assist fire students in developing and learning the essentials necessary to undertake the arduous tasks associated with firefighting. This Performance Objectives Manual corresponds with NFPA 1001, 2019 edition, and the job performance requirements.

Performance Objectives

Procedures:

1. State Field Representatives shall administer practical skills examinations to evaluate the fire student's abilities to perform minimum standards, based on the Performance Objectives outlined in this manual.
2. **The BFST understands not all Training Centers can set up and execute the Performance Objectives in the same manner. Field Representatives will accommodate when necessary.**
3. The BFST recognizes an objective can be accomplished by using different methods and encourages additional instruction to broaden the knowledge of students. However, these methods shall NOT affect the safety of the students nor the outcome with a different method than the procedures outlined in this manual.
4. **Prior to the practical examination, the Assistant Superintendent of the Bureau of Fire Standards and Training is requesting that the Training Center Instructors inform the Field Representatives of any alternate methods of instruction so that the students will not lose points during testing.**
5. On State Day examinations, the Training Center shall ensure/provide the following:
 - a. Drinks for state representatives.
 - b. A certified instructor, designated as the Safety Officer of the firegrounds to ensure operating procedures are conducted safely.
 - c. A certified instructor, designated as the medical provider with adequate supplies, to administer BLS procedures for candidates, in accordance with FAC 69A-37.062(4d).
 - d. A certified instructor or designee (cannot be a student) shall be assigned to operate the fire apparatus during testing. Students are NOT permitted to operate the fire apparatus to include the opening/closing of water valves, in accordance with FAC 69A-37.062(7b). Ensure wheels are chocked while pump is in gear.
 - e. No photographing, videotaping, or audiotaping of any test is permitted at any time under any circumstances by any person other than the examiner, in accordance with 69A-37.062(7g).
 - f. The BFST mandates a certified instructor or designee (cannot be a student) be positioned on the 2nd floor at the window where students enter the building when dismounting the ladder during the Ladder Rescue Test, for safety precautions.
6. All objectives shall be performed under simulated fire ground conditions.
7. Full PPE (Personal Protective Equipment) with SCBA (Self Contained Breathing Apparatus) shall be worn.

8. PPE shall be in operating condition, complying with NFPA, and NOT worn exposing skin.
9. All attachments (buttons, clips, snaps, Velcro, zippers) shall be fastened.
10. The BFST understands PPE may be older and/or become damaged through the vigorous training performed during the fire academy and these situations shall NOT affect the students' grade. The student shall don PPE and make one (1) attempt to fasten attachments. This is also discussed during the orientation before testing begins on state day.
11. For all IDLH (Immediate Danger to Life & Health) situations, you must go on air prior to performing the necessary skills to achieve the objective. Simulating going on air shall NOT be acceptable.
12. Verbalizing: full PPE, on air, charged hose line, RIT (Rapid Intervention Team), shall NOT be required. However, these components are essential in the techniques involved with firefighting and should be understood by students.
13. All Performance Objectives, except Ropes & Knots and the ERG (Emergency Response Guidebook) exercise, shall be completed within 4 minutes and 40 seconds (4:40).
14. Ropes & Knots shall be completed within 2:00 minutes.
15. The ERG (Emergency Response Guidebook) exercise is an open book, 5 question, multiple choice, written test. This Performance Objective/Skill shall be completed within 20:00 minutes.
16. **After instructions are given to perform a skill, time begins when the student starts verbalizing procedures and/or touches any tools, equipment, appliances, hose, or rope to execute the required skill. This includes other students assisting with carrying tools and equipment. Time ends when the student informs the examiner skill/task is completed.**

Note: *All Equipment shall be stored on salvage cover or on fire Apparatus. If the candidate must travel more than fifty (50) feet, they will be allowed to move equipment to a staging area close to the assigned task station. It is acceptable to have a second salvage cover with all the tools, equipment, hose, and appliances at a second location, if the training grounds are large.*

17. **It is NOT necessary nor required to present facemask or any tools and equipment to the examiner upon completion of any skills during testing.**
18. Before climbing any ladder, all safety requirements shall be verified and verbalized. This is detailed in the Ladder section of this manual.
19. **In the fire service, back injuries are the most common due to improper lifting and carrying techniques. These occurrences are responsible for damaged equipment and ending careers. Therefore, proper body mechanics shall be utilized when lifting any equipment and is achieved by keeping your back straight and lifting with your legs, NOT your back. These techniques shall be evaluated throughout the entire testing process, regardless of the skill being performed.**

20. The Performance Objectives focus on many fundamental skills pertaining to firefighting activities. Nonetheless, they do NOT address all incidents encountered in the fire service.
21. **Students are responsible for completing all skills based on the procedures outlined in this manual. Examiner grade sheets are abbreviated versions of the Performance Objectives and solely serve as a resource to properly evaluate the students' progress.**